



Industry Updates

MAIT in discussion with MeitY for growth of Indian electronics and IT manufacturing

Manufacturers Association of Information Technology (MAIT), along with its industry representatives, recently held a meeting with Ravi Shankar Prasad, IT minister, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and other senior government officials. The agenda of the meeting was to discuss the way forward for the growth of the electronics and IT manufacturing industries in India. The meeting was attended by several MAIT members including HP, Dell, Lenovo, Netweb Technologies, CISCO and Rosenberger.

Nitin Kunkolienker, president, MAIT, informed *CRN Media* that

they had a very promising discussion with the minister, which has resulted in specific action points, in line with the government's Make in India initiative.

Kunkolienker further informed that in his discussion with Prasad, he highlighted the need for creation of a component manufacturing hub in India, which needs to be promoted aggressively by incentivisation by the government.

Talking about PCs, Kunkolienker said that immediate steps should be taken to build an ecosystem to benefit from the large, under-utilised manufacturing capacity to encourage domestic manufacturing.

Government scraps five per cent import duty on open-cell TV panels

In an attempt to boost domestic manufacturing, the government of India has removed five per cent custom duty imposed on the import of open-cell TV panels, which are used in the manufacture of LED TVs. This move would also help reduce the price of TV panels by around three per cent.

The government has also waived

off customs duty on the import of chip-on-film, printed circuit board assembly (PCBA) and cell (glass board/substrate)—components used to manufacture open-cell TV panels.

However, the Centre's move to scrap the import duty on open-cell panels will be valid for one year, after which it would be taxed again, unless the assembly begins locally.

Tamil Nadu unveils new EV policy

Tamil Nadu chief minister Edappadi K. Palaniswami has unveiled the state's electric vehicle (EV) policy, which has set out a vision to attract ₹ 500 billion in investments and create 150,000 new jobs.

Tamil Nadu Electric Vehicle Policy 2019 has crafted out a strategy to make Tamil Nadu the preferred destination for EVs and component

manufacturing units, including battery and charging infrastructure. Under the new policy, major cost saving as part of the on-road price package will be on insurance, as the state government will offer hundred per cent road tax exemption, in addition to waivers on registration fees under the central government's policy.

ON THE move

Microsoft India (R&D) appoints Rajiv Kumar as MD

Rajiv Kumar has been appointed as managing director (MD) of Microsoft India (R&D). Currently corporate vice president of Microsoft's Experiences and Devices Group, Kumar will take over from Anil Bhansali, who has held this role for the last six years. Bhansali will continue as corporate vice president of Cloud and Enterprise, and will be relocating to Redmond, USA.

National Instruments appoints SVP and GM of semiconductor business

National Instruments has announced the appointment of Ritu Favre as senior vice president (SVP) and general manager (GM) of the semiconductor business. In this role, Favre will set the strategic direction to drive business growth and build on the company's positive momentum in the industry.

Electro Rent announces new global CEO and president

Electro Rent has announced the appointment of Jay Geldmacher as the company's new global chief executive officer (CEO) and president. Geldmacher has over thirty years of experience in building and growing businesses within the electronics manufacturing industry. Most recently, he was president and CEO of Artesyn Embedded Technologies (formerly Emerson's Embedded Computing & Power Business) where he championed the expansion of engineering resources and investments in technology into new markets such as hyper-scale, 5G and Industry 4.0.

Philip Knights joins RFMW as BDM - RF power

RFMW has announced that Philip Knights has joined their organisation as business development manager (BDM) - RF power products, reporting directly to Mike Carroll, vice president - global sales. Knights has more than 35 years of experience in RF design engineering, new business development, sales management and marketing.